



3.0 THE YEAR 2014 KCSE EXAMINATION QUESTION PAPERS

3.1 ENGLISH (101)

3.1.1 English Paper 1 (101/1)

- 1 You have recently visited a schoolmate during the holidays and thoroughly enjoyed yourself. Write a letter to the schoolmate, thanking him or her for the invitation. Describe the experiences that made your stay memorable. (20 marks)
- 2 *Read the passage below and fill in each blank space with an appropriate word.* (10 marks)

An outline is an organized list of what you plan to write about. It is a sketch of what your essay will (1) like. It is also a guide which will keep you on the right (2) when you are writing your first draft. In the (3) stages, your outline should be a changing, working outline; in (4) final form, your outline should be a “table of contents” of what you have “said” (5) your essay.

(6), for instance, you were assigned to write an essay about trees, you might choose to write about “Trees used for fuel”. In the planning of your paper, you might decide to (7) your topic into “Trees for firewood” (8) “Trees used for charcoal”. You might then (9) divide your subtopics into the different kinds of trees (10) for each purpose.

Adapted from: *Write Source 2000* compiled by
Patrick Sebranek, Verne Meyer, and Dave Kemper (1995).



- 3 (a) Read the oral narrative below and then answer the questions that follow.

The Cowtail Swish

Once upon a time, there lived a much loved village chief. He loved hunting and would share the meat with the entire village. One day, he went hunting as usual but didn't return. His people became very worried. They searched and searched for him. As they searched, they kept singing his favourite song, hoping that he'd sing back in response. The song echoed throughout the forest:

Mother nature, mother nature
You have enough for all
Mother nature, may my arrow find much meat
Meat to feed all my people

After a long fruitless search, the chief was presumed dead. Shortly afterwards, his wife gave birth to their seventh son. With his first breath, he asked, "What happened to my father?"

"Have you ever seen anything like this?" the villagers whispered among themselves in amazement.

"Never, ever!" was the soft reply all round. Immediately, the newborn's question prompted his six older brothers to embark on another search for their father. It was with sadness that they discovered that he'd been swallowed by a python. Luckily, each of them was endowed with special talents and powers which they combined to restore their father's life. The whole village danced and danced, the joyful pata pata of their feet resounding throughout the village.

Now, a big, big problem arose; who among the sons would become heir one day and receive the Cowtail swish which was the symbol of authority? Each of the six sons claimed that it was his magical powers that had brought their father back from the land of the spirits. Each claim sounded as valid and as potent as the next. In confusion, the villagers scratched their heads like chickens scratching the ground.

"Well, our land has many rivers, each with its source. Likewise, the search that eventually led to the restoration of my life had a source," the chief said in a tone of finality. All the eyes of the villagers turned on the infant son. They remembered the proverb that says: a man is only truly dead when he is not remembered.

- (i) Illustrate any **four** features that show that this is an oral narrative. (4 marks)
- (ii) Which gesture would you use while saying the words: "With the entire village" in the first paragraph? (1 mark)
- (iii) Which is the main sound feature used in the song? (2 marks)
- (iv) Identify an ideophone in the story. (1 mark)
- (b) For every word in the sentence below, provide another that is identical in pronunciation.
- Aren't you here for eight days? (6 marks)



- (c) Which intonation would you use to say each of the underlined words? (5 marks)

Malusu: Omenda, what time is the meeting tomorrow?

Omenda: (Surprised) Tomorrow!

Malusu: You didn't forget, did you?

Omenda: I'm afraid I did.

- (d) Imagine that one afternoon you see one of your classmates sneak out of the school compound and get into a waiting car. You decide to report the matter to the teacher on duty. What three important details must you include in your oral report? (3 marks)

- (e) Fill in the gaps in the following conversation so that it flows naturally.

Mark: Martha, I would like to invite you to a football game at Kasarani stadium tomorrow afternoon.

Martha:
..... (1 mark)

Mark: Oh! Why is it that many girls are not football fans? Anyway, even if you don't enjoy the game, you might enjoy my company.

Martha: (1 mark)

Mark: Thank you. That's nice of you to say. So, is it a deal then?

Martha: (1 mark)

Mark: And what condition is that?

Martha:
..... (1 mark)

Mark: But I don't like watching movies.
..... (1 mark)

Martha: Boring? In that case
..... (1 mark)

Mark: Wait. Wait.
..... (1 mark)

Martha: I don't think you're being selfish; all the same, I accept your apology.

Mark: I agree with your suggestion.
A football game followed by a movie it shall be. (1 mark)



3.1.2 English Paper 2 (101/2)

1 Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

Developers' bulldozers have been levelling thousands of acres of rain forest every day in recent years to make way for human habitation. As a result, one plant or animal species a day is added to the list of those that have become extinct on this planet. This destruction must stop. Rain forests must be protected because they offer the human race many irreplaceable resources.

Rain forests are a special category of forests found only in the tropical regions of the world, usually close to the equator. True to their name, rain averages 80 inches a year in these forests. This rain, coupled with the warm tropical temperatures, creates dense lush vegetation. Little light gets through to the ground, but on the canopy and immediately below on the trees, plant and insect life abounds and is rich with benefits for humanity.

One major use of rain forests is biomedical. The plants and animals found there are a source of many rare compounds used by pharmaceutical companies. It is the products of such companies that sufferers of Parkinson's disease and certain mental conditions have to thank. And the discoveries have just begun. Scientists say that rain forests contain over a thousand plants that have great anticancer potential. To destroy life forms in these forests is to **deprive** the human race of further medical advance.

Another reason for saving rain forests is the crucial role they play in maintaining the global natural balance. Living organisms exist with each other, meaning that when one is eliminated, another can over-multiply to the **detriment** of the environment. For example, when developers clear forested areas to make way for "civilization", birds lose their nesting sites and no longer eat the insects there. These insects flourish and attack farm crops. The subsequent destruction of agriculture causes a serious food shortage and as we know, a hungry nation cannot develop.

Most important, rain forests must be protected because their trees regulate the planet's oxygen supply. They help to balance atmospheric conditions by manufacturing oxygen and absorbing carbon dioxide. Carbon dioxide creates what is called the "greenhouse" effect, a process that is responsible for global warming which in turn could lead to the submerging of coastal regions and islands. Can you imagine waking up one morning to the announcement that Mombasa, Malindi, Lamu and Rusinga Islands are no more?

Also, rain forests regulate the climate. If they are destroyed, the greenhouse effect could change rainfall patterns so that areas formerly used for agriculture become deserts. We may not be there yet, but are we not already **contending with** uncharacteristic long dry spells that bring about famine?

In future, the pressure on rain forests will become worse, not better, given that the human population keeps growing. The pessimist believes nothing can be done. The optimist, on the other hand, strongly believes that people can work together to slow, even reverse, the pace of destruction. **Stand up to be counted.**

Adapted from *Handbook for Writers* by Lynn Quitman Troyka.
Published by Prentice Hall Inc. (1987).



- (a) Referring to the first paragraph, say why the destruction of the rain forests must be stopped. (2 marks)
- (b) Why are the forests described in the passage called rain forests? (2 marks)
- (c) Rewrite the following sentence beginning “So close”
The huge evergreen trees are so close together that their branches overlap and form an enormous towering canopy. (1 mark)
- (d) How will medical advance be affected by the destruction of rain forests? (3 marks)
- (e) Explain why the author has put the word “civilization” between quotation marks. (2 marks)
- (f) In not more than **40 words**, summarize the effects of the greenhouse effect. (4 marks)

Rough copy

Fair copy

- (g) What kind of pressure do you think the author is talking about in the last paragraph? (2 marks)
- (h) Explain the meaning of the following expressions as used in the passage: (4 marks)
- (i) deprive;
- (ii) detriment;
- (iii) contending with;
- (iv) Stand up to be counted.



2 Read the excerpt below and then answer the questions that follow.

The day finally arrived and it was a day as full of beauty as the day in which Owuor Kembo of Sakwa, in full battle regalia and a leopard skin loin piece had come to pay suit to the great Chief Odero Gogni of Yimbo for the hand of his daughter Akoko Obanda. Yet some things were different. A stone's throw away was the church with its tall steeple bearing a cross at the top – a symbol of the new and different way of life, yet in some ways reminiscent of the reverence once paid to *Were* – the god of the eye of the rising sun who had guided the people. Further along was the school – the place of learning without which one was as a blind man in a strange house. All round was evidence of the rule of the white people who were good administrators but often unjust and **unheeding** to the pleas and aspirations of their black subjects. Indeed in the Central Province and in Nairobi especially among the Kikuyu, there were rumours of mass uprising against the colonial powers.

Oloo the son of Sigu, otherwise known as Mark Anthony, arrived with his entourage of six including his uncle, at mid-morning. Aware of the importance and the impact of presence and carriage he arrived in his military fatigues, a colobus monkey headdress and a spear in his hand. He was after all a soldier. It was an **intriguing** combination of the old and the new. Anyone else might have looked odd but Oloo looked dashing. His complexion was deceptively light and it drew questioning glances from his hosts and hostesses. Had their daughter decided to marry a *ja-mwa* – a foreigner? Apart from Akoko who must have left her mother's womb with a broad outlook, all of them were strictly **parochial** and marriage to even a Luhya from across the border was considered a catastrophe. It was therefore a relief when the suitors broke into pure Luo with the dialect of the middle region of Ramogi. Their daughter was a prize, a beacon, a source of pride for the entire clan. They simply could not bear giving her away to a stranger.

"Brothers, we greet you and bring you many greetings from the people of Seme. My nephew, Oloo, son of my late brother Sigu, came to me and said: 'Father, I have found a girl and I want to get married'. Now I am a reasonable man and I know the ways of *Chik*, so I asked him: 'Son, one does not just find a girl in the air. One sends a *jawan'gyo* to go and spy a girl and find out her antecedents and character. Is she a thief or a witch? Is she lazy or shiftless? Might there be consanguinity between you and her? Who is her mother and father?' I tell you my brothers, that I was flabbergasted to hear that none of these things had ever crossed his mind. He knew that her mother's name was Maria and her grandmother's name was Akoko and that was all. You will therefore forgive us brothers because we do not know you and you do not know us. We only came because we had faith in our son who has always been a reasonable man. We therefore

wish to introduce ourselves before we go on. I am Semo Rakula of Seme, our village is near that strange rock – upon – a – rock, *Kit-Mikai*. We are the descendants of that great warrior, Nyagudi Kogambi. Oloo and these young men are my sons and a nephew. Oloo is a man of learning and what is more, a soldier who has fought for the white man in distant lands. Now he is a clerk with a big *Kambi* (company) in Nakuru, where he gets a good salary. So should this suit be acceptable to all you need have no fear that your daughter will starve.

I tell you these things because there are things a *jawan'gyo* would have found out for you. Thank you brothers". A pot of *kong'o* was moved near him and he drew a long refreshing draught. Some things never change – a spokesman always needs to irrigate his throat.



- (a) What role had Akoko played in preparation for this day? (2 marks)
- (b) What feelings does this day arouse in Akoko? Explain your answer. (3 marks)
- (c) Why was Christianity not so strange after all in this community? (3 marks)
- (d) How can we tell that the narrator has a positive attitude towards schools? (2 marks)
- (e) Make notes on what we learn about Oloo from this excerpt. (5 marks)
- (f) What concerns should be addressed before a man and a woman are allowed to marry? (3 marks)
- (g) Why do you think Oloo's uncle says what he says in his speech? (3 marks)
- (h) "Their daughter was a prize, a beacon, a source of pride for the entire clan".
(Rewrite the sentence beginning: Not only.....). (1 mark)
- (i) Explain the meaning of the following expressions as they are used in the passage: (3 marks)
- (i) unheeding
- (ii) intriguing
- (iii) parochial



- 3 Read the song below and then answer the questions that follow.

Listen! Dear Bride

Oh my sister, listen!
From this day, you won't go dancing,
From this day, you won't go to the dance,
From this day, you won't go dancing,
You'll dance only on the path to the river.

My sister, will you listen?
From this day, you won't sit chatting,
From this day, you won't sit to chat,
From this day, you won't sit chatting,
You'll only chat on the path to the farm.

Daughter of my mother listen!
From this day, you won't enjoy teasing,
From this day, you won't enjoy to tease,
From this day, you won't enjoy teasing,
You'll only tease the baby on your lap.

Listen, my dear sister!
You'll dance only on the path to the river.
You'll chat only on the path to the farm.
You'll tease only the baby on your lap.
From this day, life will change.

Have you heard, daughter of my mother?
You will not go dancing, dance today.
You will not sit chatting, chat today.
You will not enjoy teasing, tease today.
From this day, life will change.

Kenyan Wedding Song

- (a) Who do you think are the singers of this song? Give reasons for your answer. (3 marks)
- (b) Identify **two** features which qualify this text as a song. (4 marks)
- (c) Briefly explain what the society's expectations of a married woman are, according to this song. (3 marks)
- (d) Give **two** purposes that this song can serve. (4 marks)



- (e) How do you think a bride responds when this song is sung during a wedding? (3 marks)
- (f) What is the relationship between the fourth stanza and the stanzas that come before it? (2 marks)
- (g) Explain the effect of using the phrase “daughter of my mother” instead of “my sister”. (1 mark)

4 (a) Rewrite the following sentences as instructed. (4 marks)

- (i) I would gladly have helped them were it not for the shortage of funds at the time. (Begin: But ...)
- (ii) What we need are such ideas. (Begin: It is ...)
- (iii) The Board of Governors has been looking into the matter. (End: ... Board of Governors.)
- (iv) “How often do you come here?” Mathenge asked his friend. (Rewrite in indirect speech ...)

(b) Rewrite the following sentences, correcting the error in each. (5 marks)

- (i) Most people prefer playing football than hockey.
- (ii) Emachar is the most highest paid employee in this company.
- (iii) I demand to know what is this.
- (iv) The fact that you cannot be able to do it does not mean it is impossible.
- (v) “My names are John Kamau Mwangi,” the little boy murmured.

(c) Use the correct form of the word in brackets in the sentences that follow. (4 marks)

- (i) Each category of verbs (behave) in a different way.
- (ii) I wonder why the bell is being (ring) this early.
- (iii) I could not remember the (define) of the word.
- (iv) The (enormous) of the crisis was shocking.

(d) Rewrite the sentences below, replacing the underlined idiomatic expression with words of similar meaning. (2 marks)

- (i) There are some who will try to rock the boat during the meeting.
- (ii) Can we stop flogging a dead horse and instead move on to something more useful?



Answer **three** questions only.

1 Imaginative Composition (Compulsory) (20 marks)

Either

- (a) Write a story beginning with:
When we arrived at the crime scene, ...

Or

- (b) Write a story to illustrate the saying:
Charity begins at home.

2 The compulsory Set Text (20 marks)

Bertolt Brecht, *The Caucasian Chalk Circle*

“Being a biological mother is only a first step: the real moral challenge is to be motherly.” Write an essay in response to this statement, referring to the roles of Natella Abashwili and Grusha in *The Caucasian Chalk Circle*.

3 The Optional Set Texts

Answer any **one** of the following **three** questions. (20 marks)

Either

(a) **The Short Story**

Ilieva Emilia and Waveney Olembo (Ed.), *When the Sun Goes Down and Other Stories*.

“Living with HIV and AIDS does not have to be a death sentence.” With reference to Goro wa Kamau’s *When the Sun Goes Down*, write an essay to illustrate the truth of this statement.

Or

(b) **Drama**

Francis Imbuga, *Betrayal in the City*

Using illustrations from *Betrayal in the City*, write an essay on the effects of strikes.

Or

(c) **The Novel**

Witi Ihimaera, *The Whale Rider*

“Many societies have practices that discriminate against women.”

Using examples from Witi Ihimaera’s novel, *The Whale Rider*, write an essay in support of this statement.